

THE SEX LIVES OF TREES

The rumor is that the air was thick
In the beginning.

As it is during any
Honeymoon period.

The air was full of breaths
That hung in the boughs
Like time suspended in the arms
All along the slender body of the silk tree
That stood along the perimeter of the grove
In her spun gown that flashed pink in the afternoon —

The breaths were hot,
Surging with life, and
Stifling —

In the beginning there were plants.
Large plants, small plants, spiny plants,
Leggy plants, busty plants,
plants with spindly fingers
Plants with eyes underground,
Plants with cauliflower ears above;
Green plants, sexy plants, plants that
Give it up all day, and plants that
Were so loud
You couldn't miss them.

The Sibyl trees could see over them all,
Past any gate;
past the four rivers that
Divided the land into purposes
Of gold, onyx;
They would raise the canopy to see farther
Than even the present,
Some, blasphemously, said they could see
Past the umbra of the day.
The trees ruled as the aristocracy
Due to their given gifts of intellectual
And, I suppose, moral superiority.

There was a clamorous planet of plants,
They lived beneath the canopy of trees.

The rumor was,
between friends,
After Penemue wrote down all their names
And promised to call them later,
It was the roots of the trees
That crawled underneath the brush
And touched each other under the covers
Of the lowest layer of our form;
When all formation was said and done,

It was the trees
who got out of bed, first;
Whose names we have forgotten.

by Tamarah Rockwood